CLASS NOTES · TADABBUR SIRI 9

Surah *Al-Ikhlas*

Thursday, 6 August 2026 | Surah ke-112 · 4 ayat · Makkiyyah (majority view) | Who Allah is

IN SHORT

- Four ayat on who Allah is: One, self-sufficient, unborn, without equal.
- Correct tauhid produces ikhlas — deeds for Allah alone.
- Big deeds done for show can be the first thrown into the Fire.

1. Text & meaning

قُلْ هُوَ اللَّهُ أَحَدٌ ﴿١﴾ اللَّهُ الصَّمَدُ ﴿٢﴾ لَمْ يَلِدْ وَلَمْ يُولَدْ ﴿٣﴾ وَلَمْ يَكُن لَّهُ كُفُوًا أَحَدٌ ﴿٤﴾

WORD BY WORD

1

قُلْ	هُوَ	اللَّهُ	أَحَدٌ
katakanlah	Dialah	Allah	Yang Maha Esa

Katakanlah: Dialah Allah Yang Maha Esa.

2

اللَّهُ	الصَّمَدُ
Allah	tempat bergantung segala sesuatu

Allah tempat bergantung segala sesuatu.

3

لَمْ	يَلِدْ	وَلَمْ	يُولَدْ
tidak	beranak	dan tidak	diperanakkan

Dia tidak beranak dan tidak pula diperanakkan.

4

وَلَمْ	يَكُن	لَّهُ	كُفُوًا	أَحَدٌ
dan tidak	ada	bagi-Nya	yang setara	sesiapa pun

Dan tidak ada sesuatu pun yang setara dengan-Nya.

Most scholars hold it's Makkiyyah — the stronger view, based on its asbab an-nuzul: the musyrikin of Makkah asked the Prophet ﷺ to describe his Lord.

2. Why is it called Al-Ikhlas?

Its core is **tauhid** — it explains **who** Allah is, not what He gives. And correct tauhid produces **ikhlas**: doing deeds for Allah — not for people, not for praise, not for a name, not to be known.

> **"Kalau Allah tahu, perlu ke orang lain tahu?"**

3. Equal to a third of the Quran — what does it mean?

The Prophet ﷺ asked: *"Tidak mampukah seorang daripada kamu membaca sepertiga Al-Quran dalam satu malam?"* — and said Al-Ikhlas is equal to a third of the Quran (Bukhari 5015, 6643; Muslim 811).

It equals a third in **reward** — it doesn't **replace** reading a third. If someone made a nazar to read a third of the Quran, reading Al-Ikhlas three times doesn't fulfil it. Same reward, not the same function.

> **Loving this surah:** an imam at Masjid Quba' recited it in every rakaat. When asked why, he said he loved it because it describes Ar-Rahman. The Prophet ﷺ said: ***"Kecintaanmu terhadap surah itu akan memasukkanmu ke dalam syurga."*** (Bukhari 774, Anas)

4. Four attributes in four ayat

AYAT	ATTRIBUTE	WHAT IS NEGATED
1 — *Ahad*	**Esa** — one, alone, no partner	Shirk in His essence
2 — *As-Samad*	**Perfect**; everything depends on Him, and **He depends on no one**	Any deficiency or need
3 — *Lam yalid wa lam yulad*	**Azali** (no beginning) & **Abadi** (no end)	Lineage, descent, a beginning
4 — *Lam yakun lahu kufuwan ahad*	**No rival**, partner, spouse or equal	Likening Him to creation (tasybih)

AYAT 3 REJECTS THREE DANGEROUS CLAIMS

All three challenged the prophets and their dakwah:

- **Nasrani:** Isa a.s. is the son of God.
- **Some of the Yahudi:** Uzair is the son of Allah — At-Taubah 9:30.
- **The Arab musyrikin:** the angels are Allah's daughters.

Azali & abadi: every creation has a beginning and an end; Allah has neither. He was not created and will never perish — anything that is *born* must have a beginning.

ASH-SHURA 42:11 REINFORCES AYAT 4

لَيْسَ كَمِثْلِهِ شَيْءٌ ۖ وَهُوَ السَّمِيعُ الْبَصِيرُ

"Tiada sesuatu pun yang serupa dengan-Nya, dan Dialah Yang Maha Mendengar lagi Maha Melihat."

ASH-SHURA 42:11

Allah created pairs for humans and animals — but nothing resembles Him. He creates; He does not resemble what He creates.

5. The first three thrown into Hell

MUSLIM 1905 (ABU HURAIRAH) · SAHIH

1. **The reciter / student of knowledge** — learned and taught the Quran so people would say "he's an 'alim / a qari'". He wanted to be **praised**.
2. **The fighter** — fought so people would say "he's a hero". He wanted to be **known**.
3. **The one who gave sedekah** — gave a lot so people would say "he's generous". He wanted people to **see and praise** him.

> **Deeds that look big to people aren't necessarily big to Allah.** Without the right niat, a deed can even become a cause of destruction.

فَاعْبُدِ اللَّهَ مُخْلِصًا لَّهُ الدِّينَ

"Maka sembahlah Allah dengan mengikhlaskan agama kepada-Nya."

AZ-ZUMAR 39:2

6. Amalan: 3 Qul, morning and evening

The Prophet ﷺ told Abdullah bin Khubaib r.a. to read Al-Ikhlas, Al-Falaq and An-Nas **three times in the morning and evening** — "it will suffice you against everything" (Tirmidhi 3575; Abu Dawud 5082 · hasan; an-Nawawi: sahih isnad).

OTHER AYAT FROM CLASS

- **Yunus 10:7–8** — those content with dunia and heedless of Allah's signs: their abode is the Fire.
- **Yasin 36:78–79** — "Who will give life to bones that have crumbled?" — the One who created them the first time.
- **Hadis qudsi** — what Allah has prepared for the righteous: what no eye has seen, no ear has heard, and no heart has imagined (Bukhari 3244; Muslim 2824).

Reflections

- **As-Samad: only One is truly dependable.** Everything else we rely on — jobs, savings, people, insurance — is created, and anything created can fail. Plan as well as we can, but don't treat any plan as *samad*.

- **Amount doesn't protect niat.** Muslim 1905 shows a big donation given for recognition can be a cause of ruin, while a small one given secretly is accepted.
- **Same reward ≠ same function.** Al-Ikhlas three times equals a third of the Quran in reward, but doesn't replace a vow to read it. "Equivalent value, so it can substitute" is a mistake in many areas of life.

Personal notes from the Tadabbur class (Siri 9), compiled for revision and sharing. All ayat and hadith checked against quran.com, sunnah.com and dorar.net. Any mistakes are mine — please tegur. والله أعلم